

Alessandra Stampi-Bombelli, PhD

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Swiss · Italian · Brazilian · US American

Postdoctoral fellow with a PhD from ETH Zurich and hands-on experience leading large-scale research projects, coordinating national and international stakeholders, and managing research teams. Focused on applying new methods and technologies to questions with social impact. Core strengths include causal inference, field experiments, and NLP-based text analysis.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Postdoctoral fellow

University of Zurich

02/2025 – present

Zurich, Switzerland

- Co-manage a CHF 500,000 research project consisting of a large-scale field experiment (N=180,000)
- Hire, supervise, mentor, and co-manage a four-person research team
- Set up and manage the end-to-end recruitment and selection process for subcontract workers (sourcing, application review, screening, and hiring)
- Coordinate with international stakeholders (German Federal Office for Migration, Deutsche Post, SoSci, FU Berlin)
- Originate the concept and lead technical development of an AI tool (RAG chatbot) facilitating citizen–state interactions for immigrant naturalization
- Organize an international workshop on naturalization policy, convening researchers and policymakers from across Europe
- Leadership & Mentorship:
 - Serve on the academic steering committee of the annual departmental conference
 - Founded two reading groups and one workshop for regular exchange
 - Serve on Faculty hiring committees as mid-level faculty representative within one year of joining the Institute

Graduate Research Assistant

ETH Zurich

09/2019 – 01/2025

Zurich, Switzerland

- Co-designed and co-conducted multi-phase research programmes: large-scale field experiments (RCTs), surveys, survey experiments, focus groups, and expert interviews on immigrant integration
- Collaborated with the City of Zurich administration; wrote research proposals; supervised research assistants
- Applied NLP methods to quantify minority representation across millions of newspaper articles

Predoc

University of Zurich

08/2018 – 08/2019

Zurich, Switzerland

- Estimated the causal relationship between immigrant group size and integration in the US using administrative and spatial data

Graduate Research Internship

OECD, Economics Department

03/2017 – 07/2017

Paris, France

- Assessed regional labor market adjustments to trade exposure in Chile; contributed empirical analysis to the 2017 OECD Economic Survey for Chile

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Political Economy

ETH Zurich | Advisors: Prof. Dominik Hangartner & Prof. Elliott Ash

09/2019 – 01/2025

Zurich, Switzerland

Visiting Ph.D. Fellow

European University Institute

01/2023 – 04/2023

Florence, Italy

M.Sc. in Economics (*Summa cum laude*, GPA 5.6/6, top 10%)

University of Lausanne, HEC Lausanne

09/2015 – 09/2017

Lausanne, Switzerland

B.A. in Political Science (*Magna cum laude*, GPA 105/110)

Università degli Studi Roma Tre

09/2010 – 07/2013

Rome, Italy

SKILLS

Languages: English (native), Italian (native), French (C1), Spanish (C1), German (B2.2), Portuguese (B1)

Computing: Stata, R, Python, LaTeX, Microsoft 365, G Suite, Claude Code, web design (beginner for the latter)

Methods: Causal inference, field experiments (RCTs), NLP, survey design, focus groups, market research, text-as-data

Interests: Research programme management, sustainable development, political economy, migration & integration

CERTIFICATIONS & AWARDS

Mentoring & Supervision for Postdocs

Graduate Research Campus, UZH, 2026

Swiss Parliament Scientific Experts Simulation

Reatch, 2025

Project Management for Postdocs

Cubisma Ltd, 2025

Agile for Research

KEGON Schweiz GmbH, 2022

Certificate of Proficiency in English (C2)

University of Cambridge, 2013

Narration & Storytelling in Science

Swiss Institute for Training & Coaching, 2026

Negotiating a Win-Win

Rational Games Inc., 2025

Research Project Shortlisted, Eurocities Awards

Eurocities, 2024

Diplôme Approfondi de Langue Française (C1)

Centre International d'Études Pédagogiques, 2018

Project Cycle Management Diploma

Italian Institute for International Political Studies, 2012

RESEARCH ACTIVITY

Publications & Working Papers

“Optimal multi-action treatment allocation: A two-phase field experiment to boost immigrant naturalization”, *Journal of Applied Econometrics*, 2024 (with Achim Ahrens, Selina Kurer, Dominik Hangartner)

“Closing the Citizenship Gap: Experimental Evidence from a Chatbot Intervention in Germany” (with Giuseppe Pietrantuono)

“Targeted Outreach and Citizenship Take-Up: Experimental Evidence from a Two-Phase Field Experiment in Switzerland” (with Michelle Acampora, Dominik Hangartner, Selina Kurer)

“How can citizenship campaigns overcome hurdles to immigrant naturalization? Experimental evidence from two RCTs” (with Dominik Hangartner, Selina Kurer)

“Immigration and Social Distance: Evidence from Newspapers during the Age of Mass Migration” (with Gloria Gennaro, Elliott Ash, Dominik Hangartner)

Teaching

Causal Inference Methods & R Tutorial, TA, ETH Zurich (2019–2024) · Text Data in Business & Economics, Lecturer, Universität Basel (2023) · Building a Robot Judge, TA, ETH Zurich (2023) · NLP for Law & Social Science, TA, ETH Zurich (2022–23) · Big Data and Public Policy, Guest Lecturer, ETH Zurich (2022)

Selected Seminar Presentations

Hertie School Berlin (2026); Swiss Political Science Association (2026); IPL Virtual Science Fair, ETH/Stanford (2025); UZH Sociology Workshop, Disentis (2025); Integration & Naturalisation of Refugees, PZB Berlin (2025); European Political Science Association, Madrid (2024) & Prague (2023); AI Summit Zurich (2023); Conference on New Data & Methods in Migration, Paris School of Economics (2023); Text as Data Workshop, Warwick-ETH (2023); European University Institute, Florence (2023); Political Economy Seminar Series, ETH Zurich (2020–2024); NCCR on the move, Neuchâtel (2022); CIS Zürichberg Colloquium, ETH Zurich (2022)

OTHER ACTIVITIES & AFFILIATIONS

Alumni Mentoring

HEC Lausanne · Graduate Mentorship Programme

2022 – present

Consulting

Retrofact · Consulted on the conceptual design and NLP&AI components for an AI startup

01/2026

Paul Scherrer Institute (PSI) · Designed a [workshop](#) on writing effective policy reports for the Energy Strategy 2050

11/2025

Community Involvement

Ortoloco · Cooperative member at a Zurich-area organic farm, taking regular shifts in harvesting and farming

2018 – present

Amka non-profit · Sustainable development projects in Guatemala and DR Congo (health, education, microcredit)

2009 – 2014

Affiliations

Public Policy Group, ETHZ · Immigration Policy Lab, ETHZ / Stanford · Center for Law and Economics, ETHZ

REFERENCES

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